LeRobot (Python, English names) Installation Manual

Installing LeRobot on another Mac

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This manual explains how to install LeRobot, the Python drawing robot, on a Mac where it has never been installed. This is the edition with English command names (`fd()`, `qtr()`, `pd()`, ...), in the folder `LeRobot_Python_EN`, used by the book *First Programming Lessons in Python*; the French edition is in `LeRobot_Python_FR`. Once it is done, use the *LeRobot (Python, English names) User Manual* (`LeRobot_Manual.pdf`) to draw and to run robot programs.

The Python version needs much less than the OCaml version: no XQuartz, no compiler, no startup task. The robot window is an ordinary macOS window drawn with tkinter, the graphics library that comes with Python. The installation takes about ten minutes. You need:

- a Mac with a recent macOS (Apple Silicon or Intel);
- an administrator account (the Python installer asks for the Mac password);
- an Internet connection;
- a copy of the `LeRobot` folder, or at least its `LeRobot_Python_EN` folder (USB key, AirDrop, cloud drive, ...).

Commands are typed in the **Terminal** application (*Applications* → *Utilities* → *Terminal*). Copy each command in one piece, paste it into the Terminal, and press Return.

Contents

1 Python with Tk 8.6 **1**

2 The LeRobot folder **2**

3 First launch **2**

4 Troubleshooting **3**

1 Python with Tk 8.6

LeRobot needs Python 3.9 or later *linked to Tk 8.6 or later*. Tk is the library that draws the window.

The `python3` that comes with macOS is not enough. It is linked to Tk 8.5, which no longer works on recent macOS: the robot window does not open and the program hangs. Install Python from python.org, whose installer includes a recent Tk:

1. Open `https://www.python.org/downloads/macos/` and download the *macOS 64-bit universal2 installer* of the latest Python 3 release.

2. Open the downloaded `.pkg` file and follow the installer. At the end, the Finder window it opens can be closed.

Check, in a new Terminal window:

```
/Library/Frameworks/Python.framework/Versions/Current/bin/python3 -c "import tkinter
    ; print(tkinter.TkVersion)"
```

The answer must be `8.6` or more.

You do not need to change which `python3` the Terminal uses: when LeRobot is started with the macOS `python3`, it notices that its Tk is too old and starts itself again with the python.org Python.

With Homebrew instead. If Homebrew is installed (`https://brew.sh`), its Python also works once its Tk module is installed (replace 3.13 by the version that `brew info python` shows):

```
brew install python@3.13 python-tk@3.13
```

2 The LeRobot folder

Copy the `LeRobot` folder anywhere, for example onto the **Desktop**. The Python programs are in its folder `LeRobot_Python_EN`; the `LeRobotPythonEN.app` icon must stay in that folder, next to `robot.sh`. The whole `LeRobot` folder can be moved or renamed later: nothing in it depends on where it is.

Commands. The `LeRobot` folder can be anywhere (on the Desktop, in Documents, ...): everything in it is found relative to it. The commands of this manual are typed in a Terminal window *opened in the `LeRobot` folder*: type `cd` and a space, drag the `LeRobot` folder from the Finder onto the Terminal window, and press Return (or, in the Finder, right-click the folder and choose *Services → New Terminal at Folder*).

Nothing has to be compiled. If the folder comes from another Mac, make the scripts executable again (a copy can lose this):

```
cd LeRobot_Python_EN && chmod +x robot.sh launch.sh check.sh
```

3 First launch

1. Open the interactive drawing program:

   ```
   cd LeRobot_Python_EN
   python3 Draw.py
   ```

   The robot window (800 × 700 points) opens in front of the other windows. Press Return in it to finish, then `n` not to save.

2. Run a program of the book:

   ```
   ./robot.sh book/03_programming/Square.py
   ```

   When the square is drawn, press Esc to close the window.

3. `LeRobotPythonEN.app`, in the `LeRobot_Python_EN` folder: double-click its icon to run Draw; drop a `.py` program on its icon to run it. The program runs in a Terminal window, which closes when the program ends normally and stays open if there is an error.

   The first time you open `LeRobotPythonEN.app`, macOS may refuse to open it because it comes from another Mac. Right-click the icon, choose *Open*, then confirm. Allow it to control Terminal and to access the folder of `LeRobot` (Desktop, Documents, ...) when macOS asks.

4. If the folder was copied from another Mac and the application still refuses to open, rebuild it on this Mac:

   ```
   cd LeRobot_Python_EN && tools/app/build.sh
   ```

4 Troubleshooting

Symptom	**Cause**	**Fix**
The program hangs and no window opens	Python linked to Tk 8.5 (the macOS `python3`) and no other Python found	Install Python from python.org (Section 1)
il faut un Python avec Tk 8.6 ou plus	Same cause: LeRobot found no suitable Python	Same fix
No module named '_tkinter'	Homebrew Python without its Tk module	`brew install python-tk@3.13` (with the right version)
No module named 'LibRobot'	The program was started with `python3` from another folder	Use `./robot.sh Program.py`, or drop it on `LeRobotPythonEN.app`
permission denied: ./robot.sh	The scripts lost their executable mark during the copy	`chmod +x robot.sh launch.sh check.sh` (Section 2)
`LeRobotPythonEN.app` does not open	macOS blocks applications copied from another Mac	Right-click, *Open*; or rebuild it (Section 3)
To use a given Python	—	`LEROBOT_PYTHON=/path/to/python3 ./robot.sh Program.py`